



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Kazakhstan. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself — it's great that you're thinking seriously about your future. Since you're 16, just finished primary/lower secondary school in Denmark (likely *Folkeskole* up to 9th or 10th grade), you're now at a decision point with several strong options. What's best depends on your interests, strengths, and long-term goals. Let me give you an overview of the main paths in Denmark after primary school, along with some guidance:

🇩🇰 Your Main Educational Options in Denmark at 16

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education / General Education)

These prepare you for university and are often chosen if you're interested in academic subjects.

- **STX (Studentereksamen):** The most general and broad; includes science, languages, and humanities. Good if you're still unsure what to specialize in.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme):** Focuses on business, economics, marketing, and international trade.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme):** Focus on science, technology, and design. Great for tech or engineering careers.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination):** Shorter (2 years), more flexible. Often used by older students or those who didn't go straight from 9th/10th grade.

✅ *Best if:* You enjoy studying, want to keep your options open for university, or are interested in professions like law, medicine, engineering, business, etc.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

These combine school with paid work experience (apprenticeships) and lead to skilled trades.

- Examples: Electrician, carpenter, hairdresser, chef, healthcare assistant, IT support, etc.
- Takes 3–4 years, includes a mix of practical training and classroom instruction.

✅ *Best if:* You enjoy hands-on work, want to earn money while you learn, or are interested in starting a career right after.

3. Kombineret ungdomsuddannelse (KUU) or EGU

These are more flexible programs for students who might not thrive in traditional education, and they combine work placements and school.

Being of Kazakh Descent – A Hidden Strength

Being bilingual or multicultural can be a big advantage in careers involving international business, diplomacy, translation, or education. If you speak Russian or Kazakh at home, you already have skills that many employers find valuable — especially as globalization grows.

So, What Should You Choose?

Here are some **questions to ask yourself**:

- Do you enjoy academic subjects and want to go to university?
→ **Choose STX, HHX, HTX, or HF**, depending on your interests.
 - Do you want to work with your hands or start a career earlier?
→ **Choose EUD** (vocational education).
 - Are you really interested in business, technology, or design?
→ Consider **HHX** (business) or **HTX** (technology).
 - Are you still figuring things out but want to keep university open as an option?
→ **STX** is a safe, broad choice.
-

Example Paths

If you like tech and science → HTX → university (engineering, IT) or straight into work.

If you like business and numbers → HHX → university (economics, marketing) or work in finance or trade.

If you want a profession quickly → EUD (e.g., become a carpenter, chef, or electrician in 3–4 years with a salary during training).

If you're still unsure → STX gives you time and broad education.

Final Tip

Visit schools in your area (*åbent hus*) and talk to student counselors (*UU-vejleder*). They can give tailored advice and help match your personality and interests to a good path.

If you tell me more about your interests or what you're good at, I can give a more specific recommendation.